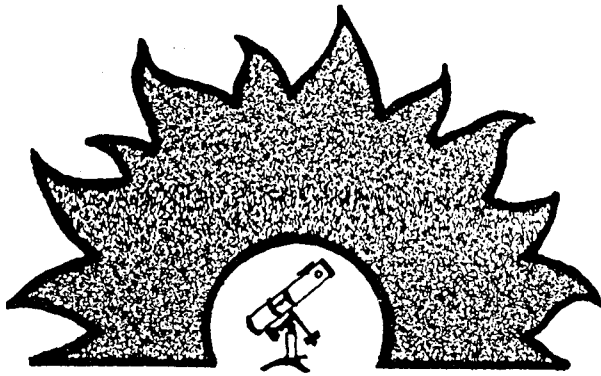




PASTIMES

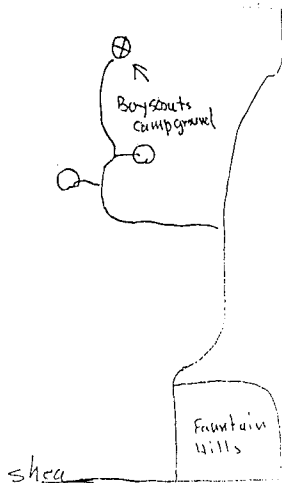
PHOENIX ASTRONOMICAL SOCIETY -- FOUNDED 1948

APRIL MEETING

The April meeting will be held at Phoenix College on April 29, 1988, 7:45 PM at the regular meeting room 102 in the science building. The speaker will be our own Pete Manley, who will present an illustrated lecture on "Weird Telescopes." Pete is always good for an interesting program and this one should be very, very entertaining.

STAR PARTY

There will be a star party on May 14, 1988 starting two hours before sundown. It will be at McDowell Mountain Park. Go east on Shea to first entrance to Fountain Hills, go toward Rio Verde. About four miles past the town, turn into the Park entrance and follow the signs to the Boy Scout campground. There will be a charge of 3.00 dollars per car. Call Raul Espinoza for details.



Circular No. 457

Central Bureau for Astronomical Telegrams
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VARIABLE IN ANDROMEDA

G. M. Hurst, Basingstoke, England, informs us that this object appears to be the newly found (17 ~ 20) on the red Palmer Sky Survey print thus on the blue (17 ~ 20) on the red Palmer Sky Survey print. The object is a Mira variable (C 4017) and thus that his suggestion that the examination of the 1976 Oct. 19 Papadopoulos chart under high magnification suggests that the image he previously mentioned is a star, for the object is slightly elongated and at a position that is slightly different from that of the new object on prime-focus exposures by A. Young. Spectroscopic observations would be useful for establishing whether the object is a nova. Hurst provides the following additional visual magnitude estimates: Apr. 3.84 UT, 11.3; 9.8; 12.0; 10.8; 12.1.

(2060) CHIRON

E. Bowell, Lowell Observatory, reports that S. J. Bus, B. A. Skiff and C. J. Cunningham obtained CCD photometry of (2060) Chiron on Mar. 23. They find that Chiron is 0.6 ± 0.1 mag brighter than in 1986 (Bus et al., submitted to *Icarus*), confirming the finding by Tholen et al. (IAU 4354) and indicating that the brightening has persisted for more than on month. The uncertainty in the magnitude change arises from the use of different R-band filters and the imprecisely known phase curve. A total of 1.9 hr of observation shows brightness variation consistent with previous observed lightcurves. Specifically, the lightcurve amplitude appears to be similar, and the rotational phase is as predicted by the 1986 observations.

COMET LILLER (1986s)

Total visual magnitude estimates: Mar. 22.79 UT, 6.3 (M. V. Zanotti Milan, Italy, 20 x 80 binoculars); 45' tail in p.a. 70°; jet in p.a. 10°; 25.82, 6.8 (J. D. Shanklin, Cambridge, England, 20 x 80 binoculars); 27.71 5.8 (S. Baroni, Milan, Italy, 20 x 80 binoculars); 30.10, 6.8 (E. A. Jacobson Evanville, MN, 10 x 50 binoculars); Apr. 4.11, 6.0 (A. Hale, Las Cruces NM, 0.20-m reflector); 6.11, 6.4 (Jacobson; tail ~ 10' in p.a. 5°); 8.11 6.4 (Jacobson); 10.79, 5.9 (A. Trebec, Nicopolis Observatory, Poland 10 x 50 binoculars); 11.84, 6.0 (P. Schmeier, Bismshheim, West Germany 20 x 80 binoculars); 12.45, 5.9 (Hale, 10 x 50 binoculars); 30' tail in p.a. 345°; 13.02, 5.5 (D. W. E. Green, Cambridge, MA, 7 x 50 binoculars).

Brian G. Marsden

1988 April 13